

POCKETS OF GROWTH ACROSS STATES, DISTRICTS



BT Research data reveals TN, Gujarat and Maharashtra continue as manufacturing centres but new hubs like UP, Chhattisgarh and Rajasthan are emerging



Exports in focus with 69 districts exporting over \$1 billion each in manufacturing goods in FY26, reveals the study by How India Lives



The BT-Deloitte India study shows India's manufacturing agenda is moving from capacity creation to disciplined industrial leadership



Among 11 hilly states, Uttarakhand has the highest number of workers, invested capital, and contribution of manufacturing in the state economy



A recent report by Morgan Stanley projects India's manufacturing opportunity at \$1.5 trillion by 2035

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industrial policies to suit their ambitions and others like West Bengal are once again getting into the race to attract investors. The coming years will show how the manufacturing map of India changes.

Going a step deeper, an analysis by How India Lives points to the kind of industrial activity taking place in districts. The results are encouraging and sometimes surprising. Ten districts accounted for close to 40% of manufacturing exports in FY26. Jamnagar in Gujarat is the biggest exporting district with close to \$36.6 billion in exports, followed by Kanchipuram in Tamil Nadu.

A closer look at India Inc's perfor-

mance through the BT-Deloitte India Manufacturing Giants list shows significant strides in both the listed and unlisted universe across sectors ranging from textiles to food processing, consumer durables, metals and refineries.

FRESH OPPORTUNITIES

Experts and officials believe India can fulfil its manufacturing ambitions. A recent study by industry chamber Assocham reveals that while China remains the world's largest manufacturing economy, new manufacturing investments and production capacity are increasingly being distributed across multiple

economies as global firms adopt China+1, nearshoring and friend-shoring strategies to build resilient and diversified supply chains.

According to the report, India's average manufacturing growth rose from 3.44% in the pre-pandemic period (2016-19) to 4.15% in 2022-25, moving from below the world average to nearly two percentage points above the global benchmark. "This remarkable improvement reflects India's growing competitiveness in the evolving global manufacturing landscape," it says.

S. P. Sharma, Chief Economist, Assocham, says India has the capacity to grow the manufacturing sector